

SOC Shift Handover – CLD-0101 through CLD-0111

Closed/Resolved:

CLD-0101 – Service account authentication failures

Repeated authentication failures for svc-backup@cloudora.io were traced to the internal backup server during a scheduled process. The successful sign-in originated from the same host, and the activity aligned with expected backup operations. The alert was closed as a false positive.

CLD-0103 – Internal port scan

The source host was identified as LDN-SCAN-01, an authorized vulnerability scanner. Traffic patterns matched legitimate scanning behavior, and no unauthorized activity was identified. The alert was closed as a false positive.

CLD-0105 – Payroll email

The email headers, authentication results, and embedded link were reviewed. SPF, DKIM, and DMARC validation passed, and the message matched normal payroll communications. The alert was closed as a false positive.

CLD-0106 – Defender daily digest

The alert was identified as a duplicate of CLD-0102 because both tickets referenced the same malware detection on LDN-WS-117. The duplicate ticket was cross-referenced and closed. No additional investigation was required.

CLD-0107 – SharePoint mass deletion

The file deletions were generated by HR-RetentionFlow, a scheduled retention automation. User sign-in activity matched Tara Kemp's normal baseline, and no indicators of account compromise were identified. The alert was closed as a false positive.

CLD-0110 – Blocked sign-in attempts

Three authentication attempts targeting daniel.reeve@cloudora.io originated from previously identified attacker infrastructure. Conditional Access blocked all attempts, and no successful authentication occurred. Existing controls functioned as expected, and the alert was resolved.

Escalated:

CLD-0102 – Malware detected, quarantine failed

Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B was repeatedly detected on LDN-WS-117, and every quarantine attempt failed. The malware persisted after multiple remediation attempts and continued to recreate itself. The incident was escalated for containment and forensic investigation.

CLD-0104 – MFA failures followed by success

Multiple MFA failures were followed by a successful sign-in and the registration of a new authenticator device. A related help desk ticket was identified, but the combination of events warranted escalation. The incident was forwarded for additional investigation.

CLD-0108 – Unfamiliar sign-in properties

KQL was used to establish Gwen Muir's sign-in baseline and review audit activity. The successful authentication occurred through IMAP4 using a previously unseen IP address and client configuration, and the activity could not be confidently explained. The incident was escalated because additional investigation was required.

CLD-0109 – Repeated outbound connections

Three endpoints across London, Manchester, and Austin established periodic HTTPS communications with the same newly registered and uncategorized external destination. KQL analysis showed no evidence of abnormal successful authentications or suspicious account changes, suggesting endpoint compromise rather than account takeover. The incident was escalated to Incident Response for containment and forensic analysis.

On Hold/Awaiting Information:

CLD-0111 – Supplier invoice email

The email headers were analyzed, and SPF validation passed, while DKIM and DMARC were not configured. The PDF attachment was unavailable for analysis, the supplier relationship could not be verified, and the user's interaction with the attachment remained uncertain. The ticket remains on hold of pending supplier verification, attachment analysis, a tenant-wide message trace, and user follow-up.

Recommended Tuning and Process Improvements

- **1. Suppress alerts generated by approved retention workflows.**
 - CLD-0107 generated an alert after HR-RetentionFlow deleted more than 1,200 files. Consider creating an exclusion for approved retention jobs to reduce unnecessary cloud activity alerts.
- **2. Improve duplicate detection between malware alerts and daily digest alerts.**
 - CLD-0102 and CLD-0106 represented the same underlying malware incident but arrived through different alerting paths. Correlating Defender detections with daily digest notifications would reduce duplicate tickets.
- **3. Create allowlists for approved infrastructure and scheduled scanning systems.**
 - CLD-0103 generated an alert because an authorized vulnerability scanner performed a large port sweep. Maintaining and updating infrastructure allowlists would reduce false positives.
- **4. Review and tune identity detections that rely exclusively on unfamiliar sign-in properties.**
 - CLD-0108 demonstrated that an unfamiliar sign-in doesn't automatically indicate account compromise. Additional context, such as historical IP addresses, client applications, authentication methods, and user baselines, should be incorporated into identity-based detections.
- **5. Review and reduce the organization's dependence on legacy authentication protocols.**
 - CLD-0108 involved an IMAP4 sign-in. Legacy protocols should be reviewed and restricted where possible because they often bypass modern authentication protections.

- **6. Create a dedicated detection for coordinated endpoints beaconing across multiple geographic locations.**